

periods where you will have to pay more interest to the Bank than it's paying you. In your twenties and thirties, when you're borrowing money for school and establishing mortgages, it's okay that the Bank's ahead. That's part of the game. But there needs to come a time when that interest starts to flow back to you, after you've paid off your mortgage and have more money to save and invest. The trick is that, over time, you want to be the one who earned more interest than you paid out. That's how you win the game. I want you to win. Some people don't get there until they're sixty or seventy years old. Some never get there. They're always servicing some kind of loan or mortgage, right to their dying day. In those cases, the Bank wins. But you can win by paying off your student loan in your twenties, remaining consumer debt-free in your thirties, and paying off your mortgage in your forties. Remember these simple rules and you'll win the game, and get you to your happily ever after:

1. Save young.
2. Scrutinize everything you buy.
3. Work while you're in school to pay down debt.
4. Invest early and often.
5. Pay down your student loan before you buy a car, or take on a mortgage.
6. Buy a home you can afford.
7. Don't grow your lifestyle along with your income.
8. Never carry credit card balances.
9. Make biweekly mortgage payments.
10. Pay down your mortgage as quickly as possible.

Doing those ten things will save you a fortune in interest payments, and get you mortgage- and debt-free faster. That's how the game of life works, and that's how you win, dear child. Knowing this, you will sleep well not just tonight, but every night. It's how you will live happily, and wealthily, ever after.